

Generation Maine

**BRAND GUIDE · VERSION 1.0 · SEPTEMBER
2026**

How to use the Generation Maine name, logo, colors, type and voice. Written for the project lead and the creators.

An initiative of Maine Policy Institute

Young Mainers on building a life here

Positioning

Generation Maine is a set of short videos and a Substack made by 8 to 12 young Maine creators about how economic rules shape their lives. Most youth policy media is national, partisan or produced by adults. Generation Maine is local, made by the creators themselves and open about who funds it.

Brand promise

You will hear young Mainers describe their own lives in their own words, and you will always know who is behind the project.

Credibility stance

Radical transparency. "An initiative of Maine Policy Institute" appears on the site, every end card and every channel bio. It is never hidden or shrunk into fine print.

Creator ownership. Creators' faces and voices lead. Their name and hometown appear on every lower third. The logo signs the work and never covers it.

Personality

Trait	This	Not that
Local	Real towns, real rents, real commutes	"America" or "Gen Z" in general
Straightforward	What happened and what it cost	Hype, slogans, talking points
Curious	Asks why a rule works the way it does	Tells the viewer what to think
Warm	A friend explaining their week	A campaign or a classroom

Stay away from

Flags, stars, eagles and founding-era Americana. Heavy red and blue pairings. Stock photos. Gradients everywhere. Literal lobsters and lighthouses.

One wordmark, one dot

The dot on the i in "Maine" is a record light. It is always round, always Signal orange in the full-color logo and never moves. The icon pairs a bold G with the same dot for avatars and favicons.



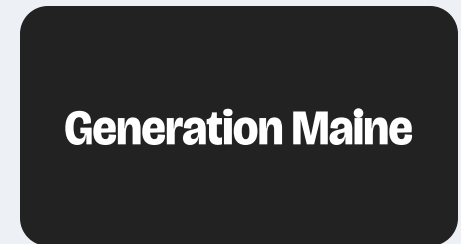
Primary, full color



Primary, reversed on Spruce



One color, black



One color, white



Stacked, full color



Stacked, reversed



Icon



Icon in a circle crop

Files: `brand/Logo/` has SVG plus 512 and 1024 px PNGs for every version, and the favicon set.

Give it room



Clear space rule: keep empty space on every side equal to two diameters of the orange dot ●. No text, edges or other logos inside that space. The same rule applies to the stacked logo and the icon.

Minimum sizes

Version	Screen	Print
Primary (one line)	120 px wide	1.25 in wide
Stacked	72 px wide	0.75 in wide
Icon	16 px (favicon)	0.3 in

Below 120 px wide, switch from the primary logo to the icon. On creator videos, the logo sits in a corner at no more than 12 percent of the frame width.

Six things to avoid

Generation Maine



Do not stretch or squash it

Generation Maine



Do not change the dot color

Generation Maine



Do not rotate it

Generation Maine



Do not add shadows or effects

Generation Maine



Do not place it on low-contrast colors

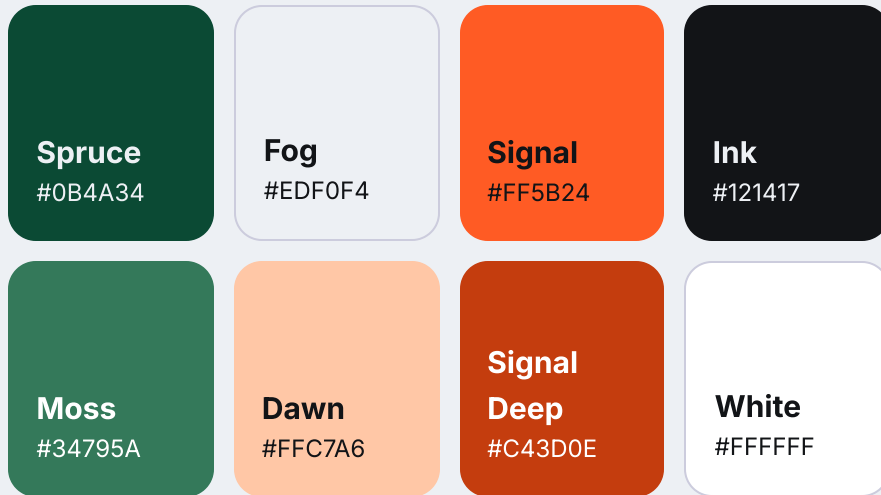
Generation Maine



Do not retype it in another font

When in doubt, use the file from `brand/logo/` as it is. Do not rebuild the logo in Canva with live text.

Mostly green, one orange dot



Usage ratio



Spruce 50 · Fog and White 30 · Ink 10 · Moss and Dawn 7 · Signal 3. Signal is a spark, not a fill.

Text pairs (WCAG 2.1, calculated)

Aa	Ink on Fog	16.14:1	Passes AA, any size
Aa	Spruce on Fog	8.99:1	Passes AA, any size
Aa	Fog on Spruce	8.99:1	Passes AA, any size
Aa	Dawn on Spruce	6.84:1	Passes AA, any size
Aa	Ink on Signal	5.95:1	Passes AA, any size
Aa	Signal Deep on Fog	4.57:1	Passes AA, any size
Aa	Moss on White	5.21:1	Passes AA, any size
Aa	Signal on Spruce	3.32:1	Large text only (24 px+, or 19 px bold)
Aa	Signal on Fog	2.71:1	Never for text

Two free fonts

Bricolage Grotesque ExtraBold for headlines. Inter for everything else. Both are under the SIL Open Font License, so they are free to use, embed and share. Files are in `brand/fonts/`.

H1 · web hero	Building a life here	Bricolage 800 · 42 to 80 px · line 1.0
H2 · section	Meet the creators	Bricolage 800 · 32 to 48 px · line 1.05
H3 · card	Read the Substack	Bricolage 800 · 21 to 26 px
Lead	Short videos by young Maine creators.	Inter 400 · 18 to 22 px · line 1.5
Body	Each one makes short videos about their own life in Maine.	Inter 400 · 17 px · line 1.6
Eyebrow	WHAT IS GENERATION MAINE	Inter 600 · 13 to 15 px · caps · +0.08em
Caption	© 2026 Generation Maine	Inter 400 · 13 px

On 1080 px social graphics, headlines run 64 to 96 px and captions no smaller than 32 px.

Contour lines, frames and the dot

Contour lines

Moss lines on Spruce, 2 to 4 px thick. Crop freely. Keep them off faces and away from text. Ready-made: `pattern-contours.png`.

Frames



Photos and video stills sit in rounded rectangles with a 24 px corner radius (18 px on small items). Vertical 9:16 frames nod to phone video.

The dot

● One Signal dot per composition. Use it as a period at the end of a headline, a record light, or a bullet. Never more than one large dot on a page or screen.

Icons



Housing



Jobs



Cost of living



Small business



Place



Video

24 px grid, 2 px stroke, round caps and joins, no fills.

Real creators in real Maine places

Do

Photograph the creators where their stories happen: a kitchen table, a job site, a Main Street storefront, a bus stop, a dorm room, a town office.

Use natural light. Morning and late-afternoon light suit the palette.

Let people look like themselves. Work clothes, winter coats and messy rooms are fine.

Shoot vertical first. Leave space above the head for a title on thumbnails.

Get written permission from every person shown, and a parent's permission for anyone under 18.

Do not

Use stock photos of smiling young people in offices.

Pose people in front of lighthouses, lobster traps or flags to signal "Maine."

Add heavy filters, color grades or gradients over faces.

Show a person in a way that suggests they hold a policy view they have not stated.

Portrait for the website

4:5 ratio, at least 1000 × 1250 px, face in the upper half, plain or real background. Upload it as the creator's Portrait (featured image).

Stories, not positions

DO

"My rent went up \$200 when the lease renewed."

DO

Name the town: "in Waterville"

DO

"Here is what the permit process looked like for me."

DO

Ask: "Why does this license cost so much?"

DO

Plain words: "The town said no."

DON'T

"The housing crisis is crushing our generation!"

DON'T

Go national: "across America"

DON'T

"Politicians don't want you to know this."

DON'T

Declare: "This law is a disaster."

DON'T

Jargon: "regulatory burden on small enterprise"

Example video headlines

Samples of the style only. They are not real videos.

What rent costs in Lewiston

I tried to open a food truck

Why my friends moved to Boston

My first paycheck, line by line

How long a building permit took

Should I stay after college?

Keep titles to 3 to 7 words. No em dashes. No all-caps sentences.

Always visible, always the same words

An initiative of Maine Policy Institute

Exact wording

"An initiative of Maine Policy Institute." Do not shorten it to "MPI" and do not replace it with "sponsored by" or "presented by."

Where it appears

Website: in the hero above the headline, in its own "About Maine Policy Institute" section and in the footer.

Social: every channel bio, every 9:16 end card, the YouTube banner and the Substack about page.

Minimum size

Website: 13 px or larger, in Inter, at full contrast (Fog on Spruce or Ink on light backgrounds).

1080 × 1920 end card: 32 px or larger. 1200 × 630 share card: 28 px or larger.

Never lower its contrast below 4.5:1 and never place it on top of busy footage.

Using the social kit

Set up Canva once

1. Open Brand Kit and add the colors: #0B4A34, #EDF0F4, #FF5B24, #121417, #34795A, #FFC7A6.
2. Upload `BricolageGrotesque-ExtraBold.ttf` and the two Inter files from `brand/fonts/` (font upload needs Canva Pro). Without Pro, pick Inter from Canva's font list and a bold sans-serif for headlines.
3. Upload the logo PNGs from `brand/logo/` to the Brand Kit logos.
4. Upload the `-blank.png` backgrounds from `brand/social/`.

Make a post

1. Create a design at the right size (for example 1080 × 1920 for an end card).
2. Drag in the matching blank background and lock it.
3. Add text boxes where the placeholders were. Use the finished PNG as your guide.
4. Check the attribution line is there and readable.

CapCut

1. Add `lower-third-1920x1080-blank.png` as an overlay and type the name and hometown on top.
2. End every video with the end card for 3 to 5 seconds.